



RAKSHITAH

GRC Compliance Platform

Governance · Risk · Compliance

White Paper

Business Overview · Architecture · Technical Flows

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1. Executive Summary

RAKSHITAH (रक्षितः) is an enterprise-grade Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) platform developed by 9USRCraft LLP. Derived from the Sanskrit word meaning 'Protected', RAKSHITAH embodies the essence of safeguarding organizations against business uncertainties, vulnerabilities, and compliance risks.

Modern enterprises face an ever-expanding landscape of regulatory obligations, operational risks, and cybersecurity threats. Legacy approaches—spreadsheets, disconnected point tools, and manual evidence collection—fail to provide the speed, visibility, and auditability that today's governance requirements demand. RAKSHITAH solves this by unifying every GRC discipline into a single, highly configurable platform that scales from startup compliance to enterprise risk programs.

This white paper presents a comprehensive overview of RAKSHITAH's business capabilities, technical architecture, data flows, and deployment model, providing technology evaluators, CISOs, GRC practitioners, and IT architects with the depth of information required to assess the platform for enterprise adoption.

40% Reduction in Manual Compliance Effort	50% Faster Audit Readiness	10+ GRC Domains Covered	100% Business Unit Risk Visibility
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2. Business Overview & Value Proposition

2.1 Problem Statement

Organizations of all sizes struggle with fragmented GRC tooling. Security teams manage risk in spreadsheets while compliance teams operate in isolated document repositories and audit teams lack real-time visibility into control status. The consequences include regulatory penalties, audit failures, security breaches, and operational inefficiency.

Key pain points RAKSHITAH addresses:

- Spreadsheet-driven risk management with no audit trail or version history
- Siloed compliance tracking disconnected from risk and governance activities
- Manual, error-prone evidence collection for audits and certifications
- Lack of a single source of truth for policies, exceptions, and controls
- Expensive commercial GRC suites out of reach for mid-market organizations
- Inability to demonstrate continuous compliance to regulators and customers

2.2 The RAKSHITAH Solution

RAKSHITAH delivers a unified, web-based GRC platform that brings together every dimension of enterprise risk management — from risk identification and scoring, through compliance framework mapping and control testing, to governance document management and audit reporting — all within a single, cohesive application.

With RAKSHITAH, enterprises can:

- Protect against Risks & Vulnerabilities — Proactively identify, assess, and mitigate risks before they impact business
- Ensure Continuous Compliance — Stay aligned with ever-changing global regulations and standards including ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, HIPAA, and PCI-DSS
- Strengthen Governance — Enable transparency, accountability, and informed decision-making through centralized policy and document management
- Foster Business Resilience — Turn compliance and risk management into strategic enablers of growth

2.3 Target Audience

RAKSHITAH is designed for cross-functional GRC stakeholders across enterprise and mid-market organizations:

Role	Responsibilities in RAKSHITAH
CISOs / Security Leaders	Executive risk oversight, board reporting, risk posture visibility
GRC Managers	Framework management, compliance orchestration, program governance
Risk Analysts	Risk identification, scoring, mitigation planning, residual risk tracking
Compliance Teams	Framework mapping, control testing, evidence collection, audit readiness
Internal Auditors	Audit initiation, test execution, finding management, reopening
Control Owners	Control documentation, testing participation, mitigation assignment
IT / Security Operations	Asset management, vulnerability integration, technical risk response
Business Managers	Approval workflows, review sign-offs, exception handling
System Administrators	Platform configuration, user/role management, integrations

2.4 Key Business Value Metrics

Quantified Business Value
✓ 40% reduction in manual compliance effort through workflow automation
✓ 50% faster audit readiness with real-time evidence and dashboard tracking
✓ 100% risk visibility across all business units via the unified GRC Dashboard
✓ Enhanced regulatory confidence with automated, tamper-evident audit trails
✓ Automated report generation — SOA, Audit Reports, Compliance Summaries, and more
✓ Lower TCO vs. commercial GRC suites — flexible deployment, no per-user licensing lock-in

2.5 What Makes RAKSHITAH Unique

RAKSHITAH differentiates itself from competing GRC platforms through five core pillars:

- **Flexible Deployment** — Available as Cloud-hosted SaaS, On-Premises Docker/LAMP, or Hybrid deployment. Enterprises retain full data sovereignty.
- **Highly Customizable** — Adapt scoring methodologies, dashboards, compliance frameworks, workflows, and reference data to organizational needs without vendor dependency.
- **User-Centric Design** — Intuitive web UI built on modern front-end libraries (Bootstrap, DataTables, Highcharts) that reduces training effort and accelerates user adoption.
- **Scalable & Modular** — Start with core Risk and Compliance modules; expand to Governance, Asset Management, Assessments, Vulnerability Management, and Incident Management as maturity grows.
- **Regulatory Intelligence** — Built-in support for ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, HIPAA, PCI-DSS, and extensible framework import for emerging regulatory requirements.
- **Open Extensibility** — Plugin-style extras model, REST API (v1 and v2 with Swagger/OpenAPI), and integration connectors for Jira, Azure DevOps, GitHub OAuth, SAML SSO, and more.

3. GRC Platform Modules & Features

RAKSHITAH covers ten primary GRC domains, each implemented as a dedicated module with its own UI, data model, workflow engine, and reporting surface. The modules are deeply interconnected — a failed compliance test can generate a risk, a risk can be linked to assets, and a closed risk can satisfy a compliance objective.

3.1 Risk Management

The Risk Management module is the core of RAKSHITAH, providing end-to-end lifecycle management for enterprise risks from identification through closure.

- Risk submission with full metadata: subject, reference ID, source, category, location, team, technology, owner, manager, stakeholders, and project mapping
- Six configurable scoring methodologies: Classic (Likelihood × Impact), CVSS, DREAD, OWASP, Custom formula, and Contributing Risk scoring
- Residual risk tracking and historical scoring timelines
- Mitigation planning with control linkage, effort estimation, and acceptance workflow
- Management review cycles with configurable review periods and status tracking
- Risk comments, collaboration, and attachment of supporting documentation
- Risk closure, reopening, and full audit trail of lifecycle transitions
- Dynamic saved filters, custom column views, and saved selections for power users
- Risk-to-asset and risk-to-asset-group mapping for impact scoping

3.2 Compliance Management

The Compliance module enables systematic framework-based compliance management, linking controls to test plans and audit execution.

- Framework and control library management with support for ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, HIPAA, PCI-DSS, and custom frameworks
- Rich control metadata: owner, class, phase, maturity level, desired maturity, priority, status, audit dates, and mitigation percentage
- Compliance test definition: tester, stakeholders, teams, frequency, objectives, test steps, expected results, and approximate effort
- Active and past audit dashboards with real-time execution tracking
- Failed test → risk linkage: associate a failed control test directly with a new or existing risk for remediation tracking
- Compliance gap analysis reports and control-family coverage views
- Framework control mappings and cross-framework control type mappings

3.3 Audit Management

- Audit initiation workflow: select controls, assign testers, define scope
- Structured test execution with result recording, evidence attachment, and comment threads
- Timeline API for each audit with full chronological evidence trail
- Active/past audit views with filtering and drill-down capability
- Reopen capability for contested or updated audit findings
- Test results linked back to risks for closed-loop remediation

3.4 Governance & Document Management

- Centralized policy and document repository with rich-text authoring (TinyMCE WYSIWYG editor)
- Document lifecycle: create, update, version, and manage approval status
- Parent-child document and framework hierarchies for structured governance libraries
- Document exception management: create, update, approve, and audit exceptions with full approval trails
- Control-to-document linkage and asset attachment support

- Document status and exception status lifecycle tables

3.5 Asset Management

- Asset inventory with valuation, grouping, and risk linkage
- Asset group management with hierarchical relationship trees
- Risk-to-asset and risk-to-asset-group many-to-many mappings for precise impact scoping
- Assessment answers linked to assets for risk-scored asset profiles

3.6 Assessment Management

- Assessment questionnaire creation, sending, and processing workflows
- Key-based external participant access for secure, token-authenticated questionnaire completion
- Assessment answers linked to assets and asset groups for risk-correlated profiling
- Assessment scoring engine with configurable contributing impact factors

3.7 Incident & Vulnerability Management

- Incident management module for tracking and responding to security incidents
- Vulnerability management with scheduled cron-based processing and dashboard reporting
- Integration points for external vulnerability data ingestion

3.8 Reporting & Dashboards

- Unified GRC Dashboard providing a single-pane executive view of risk posture, compliance status, and audit health
- Highcharts-powered visualizations: pie charts, trend lines, bar charts by risk level, status, location, category, team, scoring method, and more
- DataTables-driven tabular reports: high-risk registers, open risks by owner, overdue reviews, control gap analysis
- Executive-level risk appetite and risk posture summaries
- User-specific display settings for personalized reporting views
- Drill-down capability from executive summary to individual risk or control detail

3.9 Administration & Platform Management

- Comprehensive user and role management with RBAC permission model
- Mail server configuration, test-mail functionality, and notification management
- Backup configuration, scheduling, and retention management
- Security settings: password policy, lockout thresholds, MFA enforcement, CSP, session timeout
- Audit trail viewer with full change log for all platform actions
- Import/export capability for risks, frameworks, and reference data
- Health check and application upgrade management
- Multi-language support (i18n) via localization packs